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IMPERATIVE BUSINESS VENTURES LIMITED

Information Technology and Security Policy

Document Control chart.

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2. Background

Information technology (IT) resources require on-going investment of professional and financial resources to perform acceptably. The total expense to acquire and operate IT equipment typically involves much more than the initial purchase price of hardware or software. The collective costs of running a computer system over its lifespan can include network connections, license renewals, software upgrades, and IT support**.**

3. Hardware and Software Purchase Guidelines

i. IBVL is responsible for maintaining the network, servers, workstations, and peripherals to ensure that quality is maintained at reasonable cost. As such, procurement of all IT resources and services is to be centrally managed IBVL. Manages the purchase of IT related items in collaboration with the purchasing department, which has the final responsibility and authority for vendor selection and all purchasing decisions.

ii. A centralized IT procurement procedure benefits Administration by providing:

- Brand and model standardization where appropriate
- Office-wise inventory of hardware and software to facilitate effective planning
- Pricing advantages obtained through volume purchasing and working with preferred vendors
- License compliance for software purchases
- Hardware and software with a known “support state” at the time of purchase

4. IT Procurement Process

When a department decides to purchase IT equipment, software, and/or consumables:

a. Contact IBVL to place the initial request.

b. User Services will work with the department to verify and determine the equipment which best meets their requirements.

c. Once the appropriate equipment has been chosen, the customer will provide User Services with a valid index to charge the purchase.

d. Upon approval, IBVL will work with the Purchasing Department to procure the item.

e. Upon receipt, the item(s) will be configured, delivered, installed, and tested by IBVL personnel. All expenditure will be allocated directly to the department when purchasing via Purchase Order. For items held as inventory, the department will be billed directly.

f. All IT equipment purchased with IT funds remains the property of the IT until the disposal and media destruction procedure outlined within the IT Information Security Plan is completed.

5. Standardized IT Resources

IBVL must establish a standard set of equipment for IT administration. Standardized equipment will be updated periodically to ensure that the recommended equipment remains current and beneficial to the IT. The items designated as standard by IBVL are:

- Desktops
- Laptops
- Tablets
- Printers

- Department
- Multifunction Printer/Copy/Scan/Fax Device
- Servers (Computing or Application)
- Storage Units (Disk/Tape Units and Network)
- Smartphones (Android or iOS only)
- All Networking and Telecommunications
- Audio/Visual Equipment/CCTV Infrastructure
- Software

6. Non-Standard IT Equipment

It is acknowledged that standardized IT resources will not meet the needs of all departments. Situations may require specialized or customized equipment.

Reasons might include:

i. Specialized software determining the choice of hardware

ii. Special performance requirements

iii. Department requires an alternative to the standard configuration

iv. Officers and staff whose specific technical, environmental, or functional job responsibilities require an alternative to the standard configuration

v. IBVL will procure the requested non-standard equipment on behalf of the user once approval is received from the appropriate department head. IBVL will make every reasonable effort to support non-standard equipment, but this support may be limited.

7. Single Point of Contact (SPOC)

Sr No	Cause/Reason for contact	SPOC
1	Departmental Procurement	Director (IBVL)post approval of competent authority
2	Assessment (standard equipment)	As would be notified by Director (IBVL)
3	Assessment (non-standard equipment)	As would be notified by Director (IBVL)
4	Configuration of devices (purchased under special circumstances)	As would be notified by Director (IBVL)

8. IT User Access Policy

A. Acceptable Use of Client Systems

i. Users shall be responsible for the activities carried out on the client system, using the accounts assigned to them.

ii. User's network access shall be subjected to monitoring/filtering for malicious/unauthorized activity.

iii. For any administrative activities on the client system, users shall adhere to Security Policy for

System Administrator.
iv. The user shall take backup of important files at regular intervals (Refer Data Backup & Restoration Procedures).

- System/Media containing official information shall be physically secured (Refer Security Guidelines for User).
- Users should not leave systems unattended. The user should lock the system before leaving it.
- User shall check that the system time is as per IST. Any variation shall be reported to the System Administrator / Concerned authorities.

B. Users Shall Not Engage in Any of the Following Activities:
i. Circumventing security measures
ii. Unauthorized access to systems/data/programs
iii. Harassing other users by accessing or modifying their data/resources
iv. Making copies of software/data for unauthorized use
v. Impersonation
vi. Phishing
vii. Social engineering
viii. Unauthorized use of software license
ix. Users shall report security incidents to the System Administrator / Network / IT team

C. Hardware, Operating System, and Application Software
i. Users shall use only the software/hardware which are authorized by the Department.
ii. Users shall allow the installation of service packs and patches provided by the patch server.
iii. The System Administrator shall carry out the following activities. However, the user shall ensure the following:

1. OS and other software is installed using authorized source/OEM with valid license
2. Only required utilities are installed/enabled
3. Latest available service packs, patches, and drivers are installed
4. Booting from removable media is disabled

D. Email Use
i. Only IBVL-provided email accounts shall be used for official communication
ii. Official email shall not be forwarded to personal email accounts
iii. Email passwords shall not be shared
iv. Passwords used for online forms/services/registrations shall differ from email passwords
v. Unauthorized use of email services includes:

- Distribution of anonymous messages
- Misusing other users' email addresses
- Using a false identity
- **Sending messages to harass or intimidate others**

E. Password Security and Sharing

i. Selection of passwords shall follow Password Management Guidelines
ii. Users shall not share passwords
iii. Passwords shall be changed regularly as per policy
iv. If a password is compromised, it must be changed immediately and reported

Password Sharing:

1. Prohibition of Sharing – strictly disallowed
2. Accountability – logging required if sharing is necessary
3. Temporary Access – use temporary permissions/accounts
4. MFA – recommended for added security
5. Use of Password Managers – encouraged
6. Training & Awareness – regular training sessions
7. Penalties – violations may result in termination or 10% penalty to individual, Team Lead & Assistant Manager
8. Review & Updates – reviewed periodically; serious actions taken for violations

F. Portable Storage Media

i. Use only officially issued storage media
ii. Return when no longer required or damaged
iii. Ensure virus-free media
iv. Do not execute software directly from storage media

G. Network Access Policy

i. Prior approval required for network access
ii. One network per client system
iii. Wireless rules:

- Default: interface disabled
- Connect only to authorized networks with approval

iv. Unwanted ports/services will be blocked by admins

H. Client System Log

Users who have administrative privileges shall not disable or delete the audit trails/logs on the company's servers.

9. Asset Management

The purpose of the IT Asset Management Policy is to maintain accurate records of the organization's physical computer assets. This document establishes procedures to ensure compliance with government regulations, legal industry standards, and to ensure accurate reporting of physical assets. This policy will apply to all computer equipment and related assets purchased by Imperative Business Ventures Pvt. Ltd.

All items purchased will be recorded and maintained on a Fixed Asset Register by the IT Department. To manage the register accurately and efficiently, all employees shall adhere to the following:

1. Employees of Imperative Business Ventures shall not remove IT assets supplied by the firm from company premises, except under the following conditions:
    - IT assets assigned to employees (e.g., laptop, PDA, or damaged assets) may be removed only for:
        - Teleworking
        - Work that is outside of the office as part of an assigned role
        - For repair by the vendor
    - Exceptions to this policy must be requested in writing and approved by the Director of Information Security. Documentation must include business/technical justification and the duration of the exception.
2. Employees are responsible for any damage to IT assets they remove and will be penalized accordingly by the Asset and IT Management Team.
3. Employees must immediately report any loss, damage, or theft of assigned IT assets to the IT Department.
4. Employees are not allowed to bring their personal IT assets into the workplace for the purpose of connecting to the company's private network or data.
5. Generally, personal IT assets may not be connected to networks provided by the organization for guest or public access.
6. Exceptions must be documented and approved by the Director of Information Security, with justification and duration.

A. Disposal of Assets

Disposal of firm assets, including sale, transfer, donation, write-off, or sustainable disposal (recycling), must be done in accordance with all federal, state, and local regulations.

- Computer hardware must have all software and data securely removed before disposal.
- Highly sensitive data must be deleted using secure methods, such as:
    - Overwriting data at least three times
    - Physical destruction of hard drives to prevent data restoration

10. Secure Code Review

Secure code review is a specialized process by which application source code is examined or tested to identify IT security-related flaws or weaknesses.

- Reviews may be conducted manually or using automated software tools
- IBVL will conduct a secure code review every 6 months
- Review is performed in the debug mode by authorized personnel in a secure environment
- The Authorized IT Head will review and suggest fixes for any defects or vulnerabilities found

11. Data Backup / Retention & Purging

The Data Backup / Retention Policy defines mechanisms for the backup, restoration, and handling of IBVL information assets, ensuring:

- Protection from misuse, theft, and loss
- Availability of data when required by authorized users

This procedure applies to all IBVL information stored by the IT Department, regardless of storage medium.
The data purging procedures will be defined as per client guidelines. Only data including images and other related material, pertaining to the defined period, shall be available in IBVL systems. All other data shall be completely purged.

12. Physical & Environment Security
IBVL shall implement measures to protect office premises and equipment (IT and non-IT) from:

- Theft (external/internal)
- Vandalism
- Natural disasters
- Man-made mishaps
- Accidental damage

These risks could disrupt business operations, so proper safeguards must be in place.

- All servers and server equipment shall be placed in secure, climate-controlled rooms
- Access shall be restricted to authorized personnel only
- Access logs or registers shall be maintained for everyone accessing the server room

13. Information Security Incident Management
All information security events or incidents associated with company information or systems must be:

- Reported immediately
- Responded to promptly

The goal is to minimize damage and ensure quick recovery from incidents, breaches, or attacks.

Business Continuity Management Related to Information Security
IBVL shall implement controls to ensure information security continuity in the organization's business continuity management system, thereby:

- Guaranteeing availability of information systems
- Maintaining information processing facilities during disruptions

14. Policy Review and Approval
The Information Security Policy shall be reviewed on an annual basis to ensure it remains up to date with:

- Changes in technology, regulations, or business requirements

All changes must be:

- Coordinated with the Head of IT Department – IBVL
- Authorized by the Managing Director or Business Head

Imperative Business Ventures Limited